EDUCATION

Literacy Rate	63.0% ▲
Male: 73.0%	Female: 54.0%
Universities	278 ▲
Public: 163	Private: 115
Out of School Children	28% ▼
School Attendance	67% ▲

Chapter 10

Education

Education is the foundation of a better future for every child and a strong society. Quality and inclusive education develops skills, promotes economic growth, reduces poverty and strengthens society's ability to achieve sustainable development. Over the past five decades, education has contributed to around 50 percent of global economic growth and helped reduce extreme poverty by approximately 40 percent.[1]

Pakistan's large youth bulge can be transformed into a productive resource through effective investment in education. However, this requires improved access to quality and equity across all levels of education. In the face of demographic changes, technological advancements and governance challenges; education remains a vital tool for social stability and sustainable development. Recognizing its importance, the Government of Pakistan continues to prioritize the education sector through policy reforms and targeted investments.

Provincial initiatives focusing on skills development, expanded access and reduction of regional disparities reflect Pakistan's commitment to strengthening human capital. In this regard, the National Vocational & Technical Training Commission plays a key role in equipping youth with technical and professional skills to enhance national competitiveness and support overseas employment opportunities. As global challenges such as climate change, conflict, and economic uncertainty continue to grow, education remains a critical investment for economic growth, social stability, and resilience. Through focused implementation of the 5Es framework and the URAAN Pakistan initiative; the Government aims to ensure inclusive and quality education for sustainable national development.

Table: 10.1 Education Indicators from HDI

Country	Expected years of Schooling	Mean years of Schooling	HDI Rank
Iran	14.0	10.8	**77**
Sri Lanka	13.1	10.8	**88**
Maldives	12.8	7.4	**91**
India	13.0	6.9	**133**
Bhutan	13.2	5.8	**126**
Bangladesh	12.3	6.8	**131**
Nepal	13.8	4.5	**150**
Pakistan	7.9	4.3	**168**
Afghanistan	10.8	2.5	**180**

Source: HDI, 2025

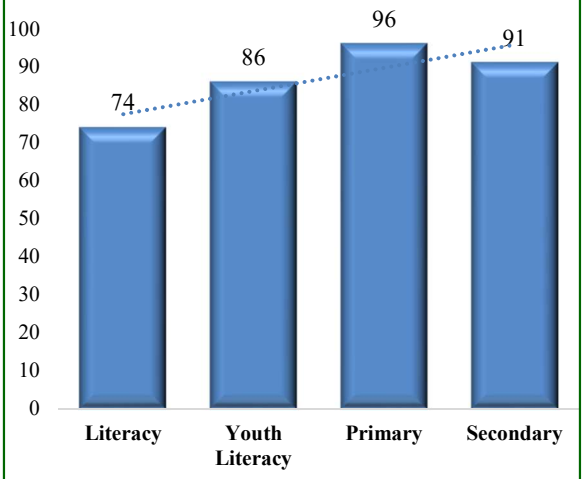
[1] Global Partnership for Education (GPE), 2026

10.1 Progress on Education Indicators Related to SDG 4

Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG 4) aims to ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all. For any global commitment to be meaningful, it must be embedded in national and local contexts. Low and lower-middle-income countries face an annual education financing gap of US $ 97 billion to achieve SDG 4 by 2030, while the global share of educational aid is projected to decline by 25 percent by 2027. This goal is of critical importance because of its transformative effects on the other SDGs. Sustainable development hinges on every child receiving a quality education.

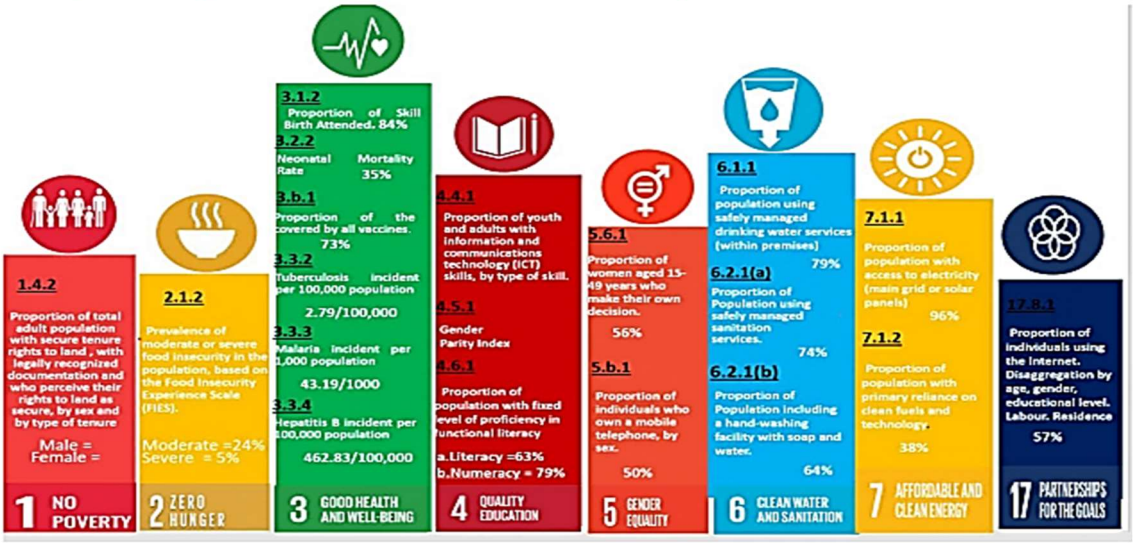
The SDG 4 shows both progress and gaps in learning outcomes (Fig-10.2). As 63 percent of the population has achieved literacy, while numeracy stands higher at 79 percent, suggesting better basic mathematical skills than reading ability. However, only a limited proportion of youth and adults demonstrate strong information and communication technology (ICT) skills, pointing to a digital skills gap. These figures highlight basic education is improving but there is still a need to strengthen quality learning, especially in literacy and modern technical competencies.

Fig-10.1: Parity Indices for Selected Education Indicators



Source: HIES 2024-25

Fig-10.2: Progress of SDGs Indicators monitored through HIES 2024-25



Source: HIES 2024-25

10.1(a) Educational Institutions and Enrolment

Pakistan's education system continues to expand across all levels, with gradual increases in enrolment, particularly at primary, middle and secondary levels. However, disparities in access and retention still persist. Detailed information about the number of institutions, enrolment, and teachers is presented in Table 10.2.

i) Pre-Primary Education

Pre-primary education remains a critical component of early childhood development. Pre-primary education generally covers children aged 3–5 years, including prep/katchi classes. At the national level, pre-primary enrolment has decreased by 9.9 percent, from 11.77 million in 2022-23 to 10.61 million in 2023-24. The estimated pre-primary enrolment for 2024-25 is expected to be around 10.4 million.

ii) Primary Education (Classes I-V)

Primary education remains the largest segment of the education system. Enrolment continued to increase moderately during 2025-26, reflecting ongoing policy efforts to enhance access. In 2023-24, the country recorded 158.71 thousand functional primary schools with 439.73 thousand corresponding teachers. Primary enrolment saw a 3.1 percent increase, rising to 25.38 million students in 2023-24, up from 24.61 million in 2022-23. It is estimated to reach approximately 25.72 million in 2024-25.

iii) Middle Education (Classes VI-VIII)

In 2023-24, the country had 44.42 thousand middle-level institutions, with 434.9 thousand teachers employed. Middle school enrolment grew by 14.9 percent, reaching 10.8 million students in 2023-24, up from 9.4 million in 2022-23. Enrolment is projected to increase by 7.4 percent, from 10.8 million to 11.6 million, in 2024-25.

iv) Secondary Education (Classes IX-X)

Secondary education continues to expand, with encouraging growth in enrolment. In 2023-24, there were 44.9 thousand secondary schools operating across the country, with 827.5 thousand teachers employed. Secondary school enrolment rose by 13 percent, reaching 5.42 million in 2023-24, up from 4.72 million in 2022-23. It is projected to increase by 6.5 percent, from 5.42 million to 5.80 million, in 2024-25.

v) Higher Secondary Education (Classes XI-XII)

In 2023-24, there were 11.3 thousand higher secondary schools/inter colleges with 299.4 thousand teachers nationwide. The overall enrolment in higher secondary education saw a 27 percent increase, reaching 2.97 million students in 2023-24, up from 2.33 million in 2022-23. It is projected to rise to 3.17 million in 2024-25.

vi) Degree Colleges (Classes XIII-XIV)

Higher education institutions are continuing to grow, though enrolment expansion has been relatively slow. It is projected that 0.94 million students will be enrolled in degree colleges in 2024-25, up from 0.90 million in 2023-24. In 2023-24, there were 2,468-degree colleges, with an estimated 2,383 for 2024-25. The number of teachers in degree colleges was 58.31 thousand in 2023-24 and is expected to decrease slightly to 57.97 thousand in 2024-25.

vii) Universities

There were 239 universities, while overall enrolment in higher education institutions was recorded at 1.96 million in 2023-24, reflecting a 1.4 percent increase over the previous year. The enrolment is expected to remain steady in 2024-25.

viii) Technical and Vocational Education

Technical and vocational education has gained policy priority, with increased focus on skills development. During 2024-25, estimated 4,746 technical and vocational institutes with 51.44 thousand teachers were functional nationally. The enrolment was recorded at 0.46 million in 2023-24 compared to 0.45 million in 2022-23. Enrolment in technical and vocational institutes remained broadly stable in 2024-25.

Table 10.2: Number of Mainstream Enrolment, Institutions and Teachers by Level Thousands

	Years	Pre-Primary	Primary*	Middle	High	Higher Sec./ Inter	Degree Colleges	Technical & Vocational Institutes	Universities	Total
Enrolment	2014-15	9589.2	19846.8	6582.2	3500.7	1665.5	510.6	319.9	1299.2	43314.1
	2015-16	9791.7	21550.6	6922.3	3652.5	1698.0	518.1	315.2	1355.6	45804.0
	2016-17	11436.6	21686.5	6996.0	3583.1	1594.9	537.4	344.8	1463.3	47642.6
	2017-18	12574.3	22931.3	7362.1	3861.3	1687.8	604.6	433.2	1575.8	51030.4
	2018-19	12707.1	23587.9	7634.1	3969.0	2139.9	725.6	433.2	1858.7	53055.5
	2019-20	12038.8	23758.2	7869.5	4014.5	2226.8	771.6	433.2	2001.7	53114.3
	2020-21	11366.6	24351.5	8414.7	4359.7	2320.2	757.9	433.2	2226.3	54230.1
	2021-22	12165.9	23848.7	8767.3	4489.9	2145.8	623.4	438.1	2226.3	54705.4
	2022-23	11771.5	24613.1	9432.7	4715.1	2335.2	660.7	453.9	1936.3	55918.5
	2023-24	10606.5	25376.2	10818.9	5422.5	2970.8	909.1	457.3	1964.2	58526.5
	2024-25 (E)	10354.1	25721.8	11629.9	5802.8	3169.4	941.5	462.5	1964.2	60046.2
Institutions	2014-15	-	165.914	44.818	31.255	5.393	1.410	3.579	0.163	252.6
	2015-16	-	164.630	45.680	31.740	5.470	1.418	3.746	0.163	252.8
	2016-17	-	168.864	49.090	31.551	5.130	1.431	3.798	0.185	260.1
	2017-18	-	172.519	46.665	31.392	5.754	1.659	3.740	0.186	262.0
	2018-19	-	180.054	47.294	31.668	5.876	2.893	3.740	0.202	271.8
	2019-20	-	179.968	47.045	31.668	5.898	2.983	3.740	0.209	271.3
	2020-21	-	180.217	47.182	34.210	7.102	3.021	3.740	0.220	275.6
	2021-22	-	162.113	47.822	34.564	8.113	2.487	4.182	0.220	259.5
	2022-23	-	168.241	51.033	39.389	9.004	2.573	4.406	0.247	274.9
	2023-24	-	158.713	44.426	44.942	11.258	2.468	4.549	0.239	266.6
	2024-25 (E)	-	154.964	43.931	48.710	13.304	2.383	4.746	0.239	268.3
Teachers	2014-15	-	430.920	380.785	514.158	118.079	36.587	19.393	88.288	1588.3
	2015-16	-	444.567	394.231	529.520	123.061	37.082	18.207	83.375	1630.1
	2016-17	-	475.235	455.445	560.642	120.336	37.857	18.207	58.733	1726.3
	2017-18	-	522.369	448.074	563.302	123.154	41.233	18.207	56.885	1773.3
	2018-19	-	494.913	448.667	567.309	136.008	61.602	18.207	60.279	1787.0
	2019-20	-	485.215	442.656	566.703	137.660	60.064	18.207	64.817	1775.5
	2020-21	-	476.513	433.979	592.307	158.386	59.455	18.207	69.604	1808.4
	2021-22	-	463.165	434.272	587.055	170.240	57.709	18.347	69.604	1800.4
	2022-23	-	506.019	511.205	733.367	196.694	60.130	40.889	98.030	2146.3
	2023-24	-	439.735	434.491	827.513	299.434	58.311	41.104	102.123	2203.0
	2024-25(E)	-	431.492	432.888	903.681	369.811	57.971	51.442	102.123	2349.4

E: Estimated. * Including Pre-Primary, Mosque Schools, and Non-Formal Basic Education (NFBE).
Source: Pakistan Institute of Education, Islamabad. Ministry of Federal Education & Professional Training.

10.1-b School Attendance, Literacy, Gross Enrolment Rate (GER), Net Enrolment Rate (NER) and Out-of-School Children (OOSC)

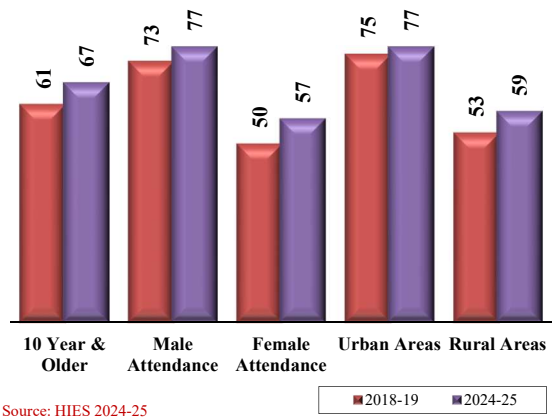
School Attendance

The percentage of the population aged 10 and older who have ever attended school increased from 61 percent in 2018-19 to 67 percent in 2024-25. Male attendance rose from 73 to 77 percent, and female attendance grew from 50 to 57 percent. Urban areas recorded a smaller increase, from 75 to 77 percent, while rural areas remained lower but improved from 53 to 59 percent. The improvement was notable for rural females, reflecting efforts to reduce the urban-rural gap.

Punjab has the highest percentage of the population ever attending school, rising from 67 percent in 2018-19 to 72 percent in 2024-25, with improvements in both male (76 to 80 percent) and female (59 to 65 percent) attendance. Sindh saw a modest increase from 57 to 60 percent, with male attendance stable (69 to 70 percent) and female attendance rising from 45 to 49 percent.

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa's attendance rose from 56 to 63 percent, with a sharp increase among females (38 to 47 percent), though still lower than male (76 to 81 percent). Balochistan continues to face the largest access gap, although it recorded notable improvement from 39 to 51 percent, with female attendance rising from 24 to 34 percent, and male attendance increasing from 52 to 66 percent. Urban-rural disparities are most pronounced in Balochistan, where urban female attendance is 48 percent compared to 28 percent in rural areas. Male attendance consistently outpaces female attendance across provinces, highlighting the link between education access and household welfare, with more affluent households showing higher attendance rates.

Fig 10.3: School Attendance (Percent)



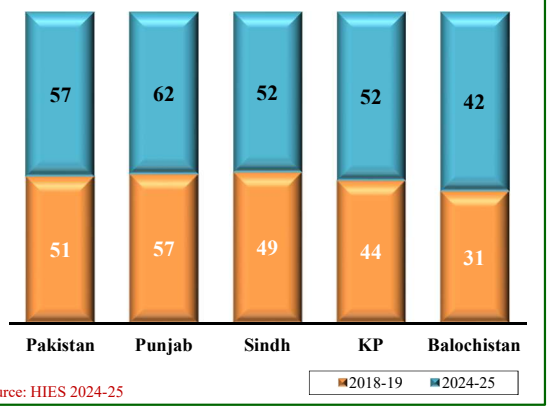
Source: HIES 2024-25

Completed Primary level or higher

Nationally, the proportion of individuals aged 10 and older who have completed at least primary school increased from 51 percent in 2018-19 to 57 percent in 2024-25, indicating progress in educational attainment, though gender disparities persist. Male completion rose from 61 to 65 percent, while female completion grew from 42 to 48 percent.

Urban areas continue to have higher completion rates, increasing slightly from 66 to 68 percent, with male completion rising from 71 percent to 73 percent and female from 60 to 63 percent. Rural areas showed a more significant improvement, from 42 to 49 percent, with male completion increasing from 54 to 60 percent and female from 32 to 38 percent.

Fig 10.4: Completed Primary Level or Higher



Source: HIES 2024-25

Among provinces, Punjab leads with an increase from 57 to 62 percent, followed by Sindh (49 to 52 percent) and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (44 to 52 percent). Balochistan, though still the lowest, recorded the largest relative gain, rising from 31 to 42 percent. However, female completion remains particularly low in Balochistan, at 27 percent in 2024-25, compared to 56 percent for male.

Literacy Rate (10 Years and Above)

In 2024-25, Pakistan's literacy rate for individuals aged 10 and above rose from 61 to 63 percent, with male literacy at 73 percent and female literacy at 54 percent, reflecting gradual progress and a narrowing gender gap. Urban areas continued to have higher literacy rates, with a total of 74 percent (81 percent for male and 68 percent for females), while rural areas had a lower rate of 55 percent (67 percent for male and 44 percent for females). Rural female literacy showed the most significant improvement.

By province, Punjab recorded the highest literacy rate at 68 percent, followed by Sindh and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, both at 58 percent. Balochistan had the lowest rate at 49 percent. The urban–rural divide persisted, with urban Punjab at 78 percent and rural Sindh at 39 percent. Overall, the data highlights steady but uneven progress, with rural female literacy playing a key role in the observed improvements, despite continuing regional and gender disparities.

Table 10.3: Literacy Rate (10 Years and Above) Percent

Province/Area	2022-23			2024-25		
	Male	Female	Total	Male	Female	Total
Pakistan	**68**	**53**	**61**	**73**	**54**	**63**
Rural	61	42	52	67	44	55
Urban	78	70	74	81	68	74
Punjab	**72**	**60**	**66**	**75**	**62**	**68**
Rural	66	51	58	69	54	61
Urban	80	74	77	82	73	78
Sindh	**64**	**50**	**58**	**68**	**47**	**58**
Rural	48	28	38	54	24	39
Urban	76	68	72	79	65	72
Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	**65**	**37**	**51**	**76**	**43**	**58**
Rural	62	34	48	75	41	57
Urban	75	55	66	81	58	69
Balochistan	**51**	**33**	**42**	**65**	**31**	**49**
Rural	44	27	36	60	25	43
Urban	65	46	56	77	43	61

Source: Population and Housing Census-2025, Pakistan Bureau of Statistics

Gross Enrollment Rate

The Gross Enrollment Rates (GER) at the national and provincial levels for primary, middle, and matric levels by gender and age for Pakistan in the 2024-25 as shown in Table 10.4. At the primary level (ages 5-9), the national GER is 87 percent, with 92 percent of male and 83 percent of females enrolled. At the middle level (ages 10-12), the overall GER is 60 percent, with male at 63 percent and females at 56 percent. At the matric level (ages 13-14), the GER is 60 percent overall, with male at 64 percent and females at 57 percent. Provincially, Punjab has the highest GER across all levels, especially at the primary level, where male and female enrollment rates are similar. Sindh, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, and Balochistan show lower enrollment rates, with Balochistan having the lowest GER, particularly for females at all levels.

Table 10.4: Gross Enrollment Rates (GER) at the National/Provincial Level by Gender and Age (Percent)

Location	GER at the Primary Level (Age: 5-9)			GER at Middle Level (Age: 10-12)			GER at Matric Level (Age: 13-14)		
	Male	Female	Total	Male	Female	Total	Male	Female	Total
Pakistan	92	83	87	63	56	60	64	57	60
Punjab	100	96	98	62	65	64	65	68	66
Sindh	83	72	77	54	41	48	55	49	52
Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	91	77	84	79	57	69	73	44	59
Balochistan	67	49	59	54	31	43	54	26	40

Source: Pakistan Social and Living Standards Measurement Survey (PSLM) 2024-25

The Net Enrollment Rates (NER) at the national and provincial levels by gender and age for the 2024-25 period as shown in Table 10.5. At the primary level (ages 5-9), Pakistan's NER is 55 percent for male, 54 percent for females, and 54 percent overall. At the middle level (ages 10-12), male enrollment is 24 percent, female enrollment is 22 percent, and the total is 23 percent. At the matric level (ages 13-14), male enrollment stands at 14 percent, female at 17 percent, and the total at 16 percent. Provincially, Punjab has the highest NER at all levels, with 61 percent for male and 63 percent for females at the primary level, 26 percent for male and 28 percent for females at the middle level, and 17 percent for male and 22 percent for females at the matric level. Sindh follows with a primary NER of 52 percent for male and 48 percent for

females, middle NER of 19 percent for male and 16 percent for females, and matric NER of 12 percent for male and 15 percent for females. Khyber Pakhtunkhwa has primary NERs of 53 percent for male and 48 percent for females, middle NERs of 28 percent for male and 20 percent for females, and matric NERs of 13 percent for male and 9 percent for females. Balochistan has the lowest NERs across all levels, with 36 percent for male and 28 percent for females at the primary level, 18 percent for male and 9 percent for females at the middle level, and 7 percent for male and 3 percent for females at the matric level.

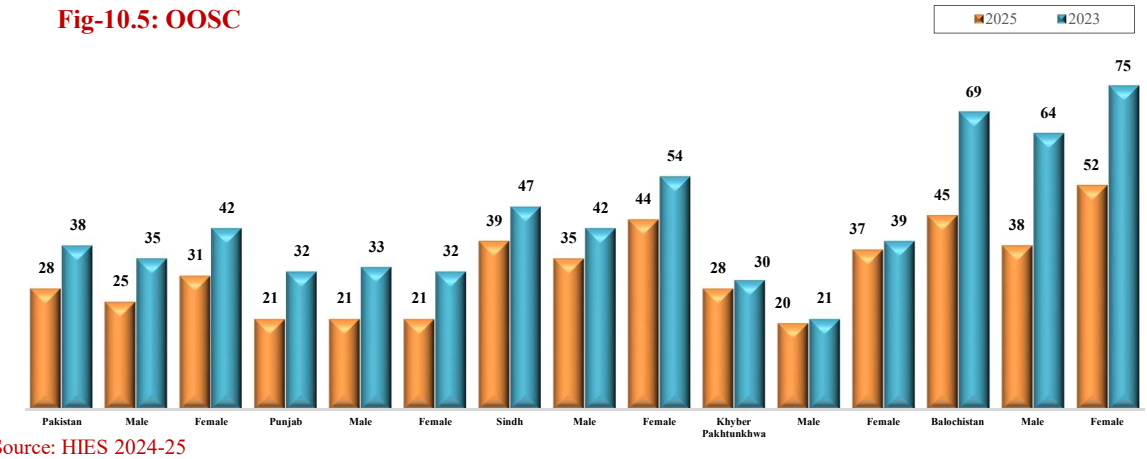
Table 10.5: Net Enrollment Rates (NER) at the National/Provincial Level by Gender and Age (Percent)

Location	NER at Primary Level (Age: 5-9)			NER at Middle Level (Age: 10-12)			NER at Matric Level (Age: 13-14)		
	Male	Female	Total	Male	Female	Total	Male	Female	Total
Pakistan	55	54	54	24	22	23	14	17	16
Punjab	61	63	62	26	28	27	17	22	19
Sindh	52	48	50	19	16	18	12	15	13
Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	53	48	50	28	20	24	13	09	11
Balochistan	36	28	32	18	09	13	07	03	05

Source: Pakistan Social and Living Standards Measurement Survey (PSLM) 2024-25

The OOSC in Pakistan have declined from 38 percent in 2023 (Male: 35 percent, Female: 42 percent) to 28 percent in 2025 (Male: 25 percent, Female: 31 percent), demonstrating significant progress across all provinces particularly in Balochistan where the proportion decreased from 69 percent to 45 percent, followed by Sindh (47 percent to 39 percent), Punjab (32 percent to 21 percent), and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (30 percent to 28 percent). The OOSC rates for Pakistan and its provinces in 2024-25 are shown in Fig. 10.5.

Fig-10.5: OOSC



Source: HIES 2024-25

Box-I: Availability of Basic Facilities in Public Schools

The quality of education is strongly linked to the quality of school facilities. Well-designed classrooms and properly maintained equipment can significantly enhance teaching and learning outcomes. Infrastructure and school facilities are vital components of a well-rounded education system, providing a safe and comfortable learning environment while contributing to the overall quality of education and student well-being. Investing in these areas is crucial for the long-term development and success of both students and society. Adequate infrastructure ensures students' comfort, while proper sanitation, clean drinking water, and hygiene practices are essential for their health and well-being. The data provided pertains to government schools, as the indicators are based solely on public sector institutions.

Around 65 percent of schools in the country have access to electricity, though there are disparities among provinces. Punjab and ICT have higher access, while Balochistan reports substantially lower coverage and therefore requires focused attention. Punjab and ICT also lead in the percentage of primary schools with water facilities, while Balochistan and AJK face challenges, with only 23 percent coverage. Toilet access in schools varies widely among provinces. Pakistan shows moderate access to boundary walls in schools, with Punjab, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, and ICT at the forefront. As schools progress to higher levels, the availability of electricity, drinking water, toilets, and boundary walls improves.

The overall status of basic facilities, such as electricity, drinking water, toilets, and boundary walls, in primary, middle, high, and higher secondary schools are given in the tables below.

Table-A: Access to Electricity Percent

Region	Primary	Middle	High	Higher Sec.	Total
Punjab	99	100	100	100	99
Sindh	28	47	80	90	32
Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	75	78	91	97	77
Balochistan	15	30	62	80	21
AJK	32	55	75	77	43
GB	53	85	94	97	65
ICT	99	100	99	100	99
Pakistan	59	77	92	95	65

Table-B: Availability of Drinking Water Percent

Region	Primary	Middle	High	Higher Sec.	Total
Punjab	99	100	100	100	100
Sindh	61	75	90	94	63
Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	84	86	94	98	86
Balochistan	23	41	70	84	29
AJK	23	46	88	92	37
GB	69	89	98	97	78
ICT	89	93	95	98	92
Pakistan	72	83	94	96	76

Table-C: Availability of Toilet Percent

Region	Primary	Middle	High	Higher Sec.	Total
Punjab	99	100	100	100	100
Sindh	73	87	96	97	75
Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	84	88	96	99	85
Balochistan	0.3	0.2	0.2	0.0	0.3
AJK	44	70	81	86	54
GB	66	91	98	100	76
ICT	96	97	98	96	97
Pakistan	74	83	90	92	77

Table D: Availability of Boundary Wall Percent

Region	Primary	Middle	High	Higher Sec.	Total
Punjab	98	99	99	100	98
Sindh	47	68	95	96	51
Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	89	93	96	98	91
Balochistan	41	75	90	94	49
AJK	34	51	53	57	40
GB	57	80	95	94	67
ICT	91	98	90	100	93
Pakistan	71	87	95	96	75

Source: Pakistan Education Statistics 2023-24. (Ministry of Federal Education & Professional Training, Pakistan Institute of Education, Islamabad.)

10.2 Expenditure on Education

Education expenditure stood at Rs 962.0 billion during FY 2025, compared with Rs 1.251.06 billion in the previous reported year in the table. Detailed component-wise and year-on-year trends in education expenditures are provided in Table 10.6 and Figure 10.6.

Table 10.6: Expenditure on Education Rs million

Years		Current Expenditure	Development Expenditure	Total Expenditure	% of GDP
2019-20	Federal	83,266	31,300	114,566	**1.9**
	Punjab	337,562	35,378	372,940	
	Sindh	165,028	5,427	170,455	
	Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	162,778	18,523	181,301	
	Balochistan	53,640	8,111	61,751	
	Pakistan	**802,274**	**98,739**	**901,013**	
2020-21	Federal	90,974	5,646	96,620	**1.4**
	Punjab	348,460	32,964	381,424	
	Sindh	183,718	10,538	194,256	
	Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	35,816	28,250	64,066	
	Balochistan	55,924	9,936	65,860	
	Pakistan	**714,892**	**87,334**	**802,226**	

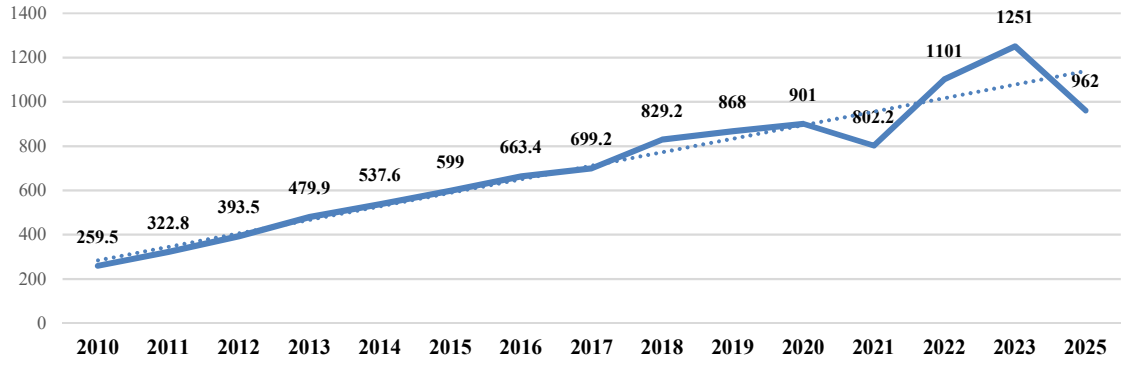
Table 10.6: Expenditure on Education Rs million

Years		Current Expenditure	Development Expenditure	Total Expenditure	% of GDP
2021-22	Federal	26,910	30,945	57,855	**1.7**
	Punjab	389,264	46,535	435,799	
	Sindh	212,721	8,105	220,826	
	Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	277,030	33,596	310,626	
	Balochistan	67,995	8,553	76,548	
	Pakistan	**973,920**	**127,734**	**1,101,654**	
2022-23	Federal	97,857	51,186	149,043	**1.5**
	Punjab	448,529	44,199	492,728	
	Sindh	251,203	12,354	263,557	
	Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	240,898	12,996	253,894	
	Balochistan	80,439	11,394	91,833	
	Pakistan	**1,118,926**	**132,129**	**1,251,055**	
2024-25	Federal	110,677	72,509	183,186	**0.8**
	Punjab	116,583	61,402	177,985	
	Sindh	339,747	29,392	369,139	
	Khyber Pakhtunkhwa(P)	67,046	27,740	94,786	
	Balochistan	111,021	25,912	136,933	
	Pakistan	**745,074**	**216,955**	**962,029**	
2025-26(P) (Jul-Mar)	Federal	28,637	17,635	46,272	-
	Punjab	149,265	26,500	175,766	
	Sindh	90,580	14,902	105,482	
	Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	20,754	3,236	23,990	
	Balochistan	4,452	538	4,990	
	Pakistan	**293,689**	**62,811**	**356,499**	

P: Provisional

Source: PRSP Budgetary Expenditures, External Finance Policy Wing, Finance Division, Islamabad.

Fig-10.6: Expenditure on Education (Rs billion)



Source: PRSP Budgetary Expenditures, External Finance Policy Wing, Finance Division, Islamabad

10.3 Development Programmes FY 2026

10.3-a Federal Public Sector Development Programme (PSDP) FY 2026

Despite financial constraints, the federal government remains committed to ensuring sufficient investment in education and skills development, alongside efficient public spending to meet national learning objectives. In the PSDP for FY 2026, Rs 78.4 billion has been allocated to the education sector, including higher education. During FY 2026, the Ministry of Federal Education and Professional Training is implementing 17 projects and schemes related to basic and higher education, including 14 ongoing and 3 new initiatives, with a total

allocation of Rs 32.1 billion. This includes the establishment of 12 new Daanish Schools in ICT, Azad Jammu & Kashmir (AJK), Gilgit-Baltistan (GB), and Balochistan, with an allocated budget of Rs 14.8 billion.

10.3-b Provincial Governments

Provincial governments have made substantial efforts to improve the education sector by addressing gaps in facilities, enhancing physical infrastructure, and establishing IT and science laboratories. They have also worked on upgrading primary schools (for both girls and boys) to middle, high, and secondary levels, constructing new schools and colleges, and offering scholarships through endowment funds and other financial assistance programmes.

Punjab

The Annual Development Programme (ADP) 2025-26 of Punjab demonstrates a substantial allocation of Rs 100 billion for the School Education sector, encompassing 17 development schemes, including 3 ongoing schemes, 8 new schemes, and 6 schemes under the Other Development Programme (ODP). A dominant share of this allocation, Rs 82.5 billion, is earmarked under the ODP, with Rs 42.5 billion specifically allocated to public–private partnership initiatives, including outsourcing of public schools through PEIMA (Rs 4 billion), support to PEF (Rs 35 billion), and funding for Punjab Danish Schools and Centres of Excellence (Rs 3.5 billion). In addition, Rs 40 billion under Chief Minister's initiatives within ODP is directed toward core infrastructure interventions such as construction of additional classrooms (Rs 25 billion), provision of missing facilities and IT laboratories (Rs 10 billion), and reconstruction of dangerous school buildings (Rs 5 billion), primarily executed through PEIMA.

The development portfolio further includes key new initiatives such as the Chief Minister's School Meal Programme (Rs 7 billion) and the establishment of Schools of Eminence (Rs 5 billion), alongside foreign-aided projects focusing on system transformation and STEM education. Ongoing schemes include major interventions like the GRADES programme aimed at improving access and quality of education service delivery. Complementing the formal school sector, the Literacy and Non-Formal Education sector has been allocated Rs 4 billion across 5 schemes, primarily focused on expanding non-formal education access through regional programmes in Central, South, and North Punjab, as well as the introduction of the NFE BEACON initiative to enhance community outreach and learning opportunities. Collectively, these investments reflect a strategic policy orientation toward strengthening education infrastructure, scaling public-private partnerships, enhancing service delivery mechanisms, and expanding inclusive and non-formal learning opportunities, thereby reinforcing the provincial government's commitment to improving access, equity, and quality across the education sector.

Sindh

In ADP for 2025-26 of Sindh, the education sector in Sindh reflects a significant fiscal commitment to both infrastructure and systemic reform. The provincial government has allocated a total of Rs 102.8 billion for education under the ADP, with the School Education Department alone receiving Rs 17.82 billion from provincial funds and an additional Rs 9.33 billion through the federal PSDP. The strategic focus of these investments remains on rehabilitating school facilities, restoring flood-damaged infrastructure, and fostering inclusive learning environments. Notable operational allocations include Rs 16.4 billion for the Sindh Education Foundation (SEF), Rs 5.0 billion for free textbooks, and a specialized Rs 100 million for STEAM and Foundation Learning initiatives to support this large education system. The province has earmarked Rs 39.07 billion for Employee Related Expenses supporting over 20,000 posts and Rs 14.44 billion for operating expenses such as utilities and contractual services. This multi-layered financial strategy aims to bridge the gap between access and quality across Sindh province during FY 2026.

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

In the ADP 2025-26, the Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa demonstrated a robust commitment to the Elementary and Secondary

Education sector with a total budgetary allocation of Rs 13.51 billion. This fiscal framework encompasses 96 development schemes, reflecting a strategic balance between maintaining continuity and fostering innovation. A major portion of the funding, amounting to Rs 12,780.4 million, is dedicated to 67 ongoing schemes to ensure the completion of critical infrastructure and educational services already in progress. Notable among these is the reconstruction of 760 non-strategic earthquake-affected schools (Rs 413.436 million) and the significant Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Human Capital Investment Project (KPHCIP), which is supported by Rs 5,040 million in foreign funding. Simultaneously, the province is expanding its educational footprint through 29 new initiatives with an initial allocation of Rs 732.772 million. These forward-looking projects focus on modernizing the learning environment and include pilot programs for Tele-Taleem /Online Education, the establishment of Smart Classrooms for STEM, and the creation of a teacher licensing regulatory body. Furthermore, the government is prioritizing inclusivity and access in the Merged Areas through the Accelerated Implementation Programme (AIP), which targets the solarization of schools, the reconstruction of damaged facilities, and the provision of stipends to students. This comprehensive approach underscores Khyber Pakhtunkhwa's dual objective of strengthening its foundational education framework while integrating technological advancements and broader regional access.

Balochistan

Balochistan's PSDP for 2025-26 reflects an enhanced commitment to education as part of the province's broader socio-economic development strategy. Under the provincial budget for FY 2026, Balochistan has allocated approximately Rs 249.5 billion for the PSDP, marking a substantial investment in development priorities across sectors including infrastructure, irrigation, health, and education. Within this development programme, the education sector comprising school and higher education development has been allocated around Rs 24.84 billion, underscoring the government's focus on improving educational infrastructure, recruiting teachers, and introducing modern facilities to strengthen learning outcomes. This allocation represents a significant portion of the provincial development budget and signals a strategic emphasis on strengthening human capital through enhanced access to quality education, including upgrading existing institutions and expanding educational services across the province. These investments reinforce Balochistan's recognition of education as a critical driver of long-term socio-economic progress and human development.

Azad Jammu and Kashmir (AJK)

The AJK ADP for 2025-26 allocates a total development outlay of Rs 49 billion, maintaining a strong focus on the social sector with Elementary & Secondary Education as a cornerstone of provincial growth. For the FY 2026, the total allocation for the Elementary & Secondary Education sub-sector is set at Rs 3.1 billion, complemented by an additional Rs 500 million in Foreign Aid. This investment supports 21 distinct schemes aimed at expanding access and quality across all levels. Specifically, Secondary Education receives the largest share of this sub-sector's budget with Rs 1,960.60 million designated for 10 new schemes, while Primary Education is allocated Rs 882.74 million plus Foreign Aid to sustain ongoing projects. Additionally, Rs 209.95 million is directed toward Middle Education and Rs 46.699 million toward Higher Secondary Education to finalize ongoing infrastructure improvements. Through these targeted financial resources, the programme aims to achieve a cumulative physical progress of 39 percent across the sub-sector by June 2026, reinforcing the region's commitment to inclusive educational outcomes and modernized learning environments.

Gilgit-Baltistan

The Gilgit-Baltistan ADP for 2024-25 reflects a robust commitment to human capital development, with the School Education sector receiving a total allocation of Rs 1.45 billion for the fiscal year. This investment is distributed across 259 total projects, comprising 212 ongoing schemes allocated Rs 1,317.557 million

and 47 new initiatives allocated Rs 136.63 million. Furthermore, the region has prioritized specialized learning through the Higher Technical and Special School Education sector, which has been allocated Rs 658.846 million for 58 schemes, including 44 ongoing and 14 new projects. These strategic allocations, part of the broader Rs 37 billion development component, focus on enhancing school infrastructure and service delivery to improve educational inclusivity and quality across the territory.

10.4 Technical and Vocational Education

National Vocational & Technical Training Commission (NAVTTC)

The NAVTTC is the apex body responsible for regulating, promoting, and providing policy direction for Pakistan's Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) sector. In addition to its regulatory role, NAVTTC implements the Prime Minister's Youth Skill Development Program to equip youth with industry-relevant and emerging skills for productive employment. The Commission also oversees skill verification and certification initiatives to strengthen workforce standards. During the past three years, NAVTTC introduced major reforms in skills training, institute registration and accreditation, assessor licensing, revision of the National Vocational Qualification Framework (NVQF), skill verification programs, and innovative financing models to build a more responsive and employment-oriented TVET system. The initiatives undertaken during FY 2026 are as follows:

a) Skills Training under PMYSDP (2024-27)

During FY 2025, NAVTTC, through Public and Private sector training institutes, provided training to more than 100,000 youth in IT, industrial and conventional trades. The summarized position is given below:

Sr. #	Project Name	Target Trainees	Duration	Status
1	Prime Minister's Youth Skills Development Program (2023-27)	77,216	2,3,4 & 6 Months	Ongoing
2	Industry Led Training with Industrial Associations	4,065	3 & 6 Months	Ongoing
3	Huawei High-Tech Training Initiative	2000	3 Months	Completed
4	Upskilling Initiative with NETSOL Institute of AI (NIAI)	200	3 Months	Ongoing
5	Prime Minister's Program for Overseas Employment	6,015	10 Weeks	Ongoing
6	Skill Training of Madrassa Youth	5000	3 & 6 Months	Ongoing
7	Training of youth in Newly Merged Districts	750	3 & 6 Months	Ongoing
8	End to End Program Leading to Employment	2820	3 & 6 Months	Ongoing
9	NAVTTC Blended Learning International IT Trainings	638	3 Months	Ongoing
10	Summer of Code	6591	3 Months	Ongoing
11	Cluster Based Trainings	6400	3 Months	Ongoing
12	High Impact IT Training in FDE Colleges	843	3 Months	Ongoing

b) Registration, Accreditation and Assessor's Licensing regime

NAVTTC has strengthened its regulatory framework through an integrated system of registration, accreditation, and assessor licensing to ensure quality assurance in the TVET sector. Following the operationalization of the registration portal and implementation of SOPs 2024, a total of 1,503 institutes were registered based on compliance with prescribed standards, ensuring transparency, merit, and quality in institutional onboarding.

In parallel, reforms in the accreditation framework have been undertaken through revision of accreditation manuals and development of an Accreditation Management System (AMS) to digitize and streamline processes. Furthermore, NAVTTC enhanced its quality assurance mechanism by issuing licenses to 1,600 National Assessors during 2025-26 after qualifying standardized assessments. Collectively, these initiatives ensure that only compliant institutions and certified professionals are engaged in skills training delivery, thereby improving the overall quality, credibility, and standardization of Pakistan's TVET system.

c) Skills Standards & Curriculum

NAVTTC continued its efforts towards the development and standardization of curricula and qualifications aligned with emerging sectoral and technological demands. During 2025-26, significant progress has been made by introducing new qualifications and modernizing curricula in high-growth sectors, ensuring alignment with both national priorities and international trends. Summary of the Targets and achievements during the reporting period is given as follows:

Targets Achieved	Reforms in Progress
Total Qualifications developed in one year till 31st March 2026 = 70	1. Development of 07 trades under Energy, Agriculture and Water Sector 2. Development of DAE technology qualifications, in coordination with the British Council, in the following specializations: i. Software Engineering ii. Computer Engineering iii. IT iv. Cyber Security v. Network Infrastructure & Cloud Computing vi. Robotics & Internet of Things (IoT) vii. Artificial Intelligence viii. Quantum Computing ix. Game Development x. Multimedia Animation and xi. Modern Data Engineering & Financial Data Analytics

d) Innovative Financing Model:

In addition to its ongoing initiatives, NAVTTC has introduced the Pakistan Skills Impact Bond (PSIB), an innovative financing model aimed at promoting outcome-based skills development in Pakistan. The PSIB links training investments directly with measurable employment outcomes, including job placement, retention, and income enhancement, addressing the challenges of skills mismatch and youth unemployment.

Under this model, NAVTTC has transitioned towards a results-based financing mechanism, ensuring efficient utilization of public resources and attracting private sector participation. Focused on high-demand sectors such as IT, construction, manufacturing, and services, the programme also emphasizes inclusion of youth aged 18 to 35 years, particularly women and underserved groups, while promoting sustainability by reducing reliance on public funding and ensuring transparency through robust monitoring of outcomes.

e) Skill Verification Program (TAKAMOL & RPL)

Under the Takamol-Skill Verification Program, NAVTTC conducted 366,157 assessments during July-March FY 2026 for candidates with confirmed employment visas for the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia (KSA). Out of these, 292,556 candidates qualified, reflecting an overall pass rate of approximately 80 percent. The programme supports certification of workers proceeding for overseas employment, thereby strengthening workforce standards and supporting remittance inflows.

In addition, under the Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) initiative, around 30,000 skilled workers were assessed and certified based on their existing competencies. The RPL programme facilitates formal recognition of informally acquired skills, improving employability and enabling workforce inclusion in both domestic and international job markets.

10.5 Higher Education Commission (HEC)

Higher Education Commission (HEC) provides overall strategic guidance and enabling environment for reforms in higher education sector since 2002. HEC is a forum for higher level decision making and interface with the federal political leadership. The HEC facilitates the higher education institutions of Pakistan to become world-class centers of education, research and development. The quality education and research have become the key

drivers for socio-economic development in the globalized world. There are 163 public universities, and 115 private universities with a total 278 universities across country. In terms of full-time faculty non-PhD faculty members are 40,360 and 24,366 (37.6 percent) PhD faculty members making a total of 64,726.

The HEC has taken numerous measures to address the above-mention key areas like; substantial expansion in education, human resource development, ICT/Physical Infrastructure Development to enhance the quality of education and research in the country.

Key Achievements during (July-March/April 2025-26):

Following are key achievements during the reporting period:

Public Sector Development Program (PSDP):

Under the PSDP 2025–26, the Higher Education Commission (HEC) has a revised allocation of Rs 34.905 billion for implementation of 147 development projects of Public Sector universities and HEC.

Following major development initiatives have been launched:

i. Allama Muhammad Iqbal Scholarships for Bangladesh, Central Asian and Friendly Countries' students to study in Pakistan

ii. Establishment of National Institute of Science & Technology in District Rajanpur, Punjab

iii. Hostels for UET Lahore and Sub-Campuses

iv. Pak-UK Education Gateway (Phase-II)

v. Prime Minister's Scheme for Enabling Youth with Physical Challenges at HEIs through Electric Wheelchairs, Laptops for Blinds, Audio-Visual Aids

vi. Establishment of Public Sector University in District Muzaffargarh, Punjab

Out of the total allocation, the government authorized an amount of Rs 31.439 billion (79.6 percent) up to 3rd Quarter (Jan-March, 2026) and HEC released Rs 31.377 billion to development projects of universities and HEC.

Summary of PSDP 2025-26 is as under: Rs million

Sr #	Description	No. of Projects	Approved Cost	Throw-forward 01.07. 2025	PSDP Allocation			Releases
					Original	Surrender	Revised	
1	Ongoing Schemes	129	370,712.317	211,518.859	38,488.216	4,459.665	34,316.277	30,917.098
2	New Schemes	12	31,849.813	31,849.813	1,000.000	123.000	334.119	205.000
3	Previous PSDP	6	18,820.198	43.536	-	-	255.155	255.155
Total		**147**	**421,382.328**	**243,412.208**	**39,488.216**	**4,582.665**	**34,905.551**	**31,377.253**

Furthermore, during the FY 2026, 17 projects have been planned for completion during the current fiscal year.

Human Resource Development: HEC remains committed to enhancing the country's human capital by implementing a wide range of scholarship initiatives, both domestic and international. These programmes are strategically designed to promote equitable access to higher education, with particular emphasis on underserved regions such as Balochistan, erstwhile FATA, and Gilgit-Baltistan, alongside fostering global academic linkages. During FY 2026, Rs 7.143 billion was allocated for 17 scholarship projects, of which Rs 5.898 billion was disbursed during the reporting period.

At present, around 20 flagship scholarship projects are under active implementation:

- 5,383 scholarships have been awarded locally across undergraduate, MS/MPhil, and PhD programmes.
- More than 540 scholarships have been facilitated for studies abroad through initiatives such as IRSIP, bilateral collaborations, and overseas PhD schemes.

A substantial cohort of scholars is currently pursuing studies, while more than 16,000 scholars so far have successfully completed their academic programmes.

Major Achievements and Progress

- International Research Support Initiative Program (IRSIP): A total of 317 scholarships awarded, out of which 159 have been completed. Batch-58 (130 scholars) has concluded, while Batch-59 has been approved with revised eligibility criteria.
- Balochistan & Erstwhile FATA Scholarship Programs (Phase-II & III): More than 6,300 scholarships awarded, with over 2,500 completions and 4,000+ scholars currently enrolled. Batch-IV (1,000 scholarships) is at the final stage of selection and implementation.
- HEC Need-Based Scholarship Program: 1,278 scholarships awarded, with 2,091 completions, demonstrating continued support for financially disadvantaged students.
- BISP Undergraduate Scholarships: Benefiting 10,497 students, with the programme scheduled for completion by June 30, 2026.
- Academic & Research Linkages (Bilateral Programs): A total of 213 scholarships awarded across various levels. An MoU has been signed with Hungary under the Stipendium Hungaricum Programme (2026–2028), offering up to 400 scholarships annually.
- Overseas PhD Scholarship Program (Phase-III): Renewal of agreements with leading international institutions is underway, while the revised PC-I is under consideration at CDWP/ECNEC.
- US-Pakistan Knowledge Corridor: Scholarships announced for multiple academic intakes up to Fall 2026. GRE preparatory workshops are being initiated in collaboration with leading institutions such as NUST and UET.
- Indigenous PhD Program (Phase-II): Supporting 160 scholars, with Phase-III currently under development.
- Faculty Development & Exchange Programs: The programme has been revamped, with awareness and launching activities conducted in February 2026. Faculty exchange initiatives (both local and international) have been successfully executed.
- Allama Iqbal Scholarships (For International Students): Enrollment of students at undergraduate, MS, and PhD levels continues, strengthening academic cooperation with friendly countries.

Research & Innovation

National Research Programme for Universities (NRPU):

- The call for applications for FY 2026 was launched in October 2025, receiving 6,926 applications, from which 143 research projects were approved with a total cost of Rs 1,271 million.
- 320 research projects were successfully completed during the period.

Technology Development Fund (TDF)

- A total of 100 project documentaries highlighting technological outcomes and commercialization potential were produced and showcased at the successfully held Technology Impact Showcasing (TIS'25) event on 30 December 2025.
- A comprehensive third-party evaluation report assessing project outcomes and impact was completed, following which 24 projects submitted their 1st Annual Reports to enable the release of their 2nd installment.
- PC-I of TDF Phase II was developed and submitted for CDWP consideration and inclusion in PSDP 2026-27.
- Concept note developed on “Pakistan International Matching Grant Fund (PIMGF)”.

Business Incubation Centers (BICs) – Innovation Support Fund (ISF)

- The call for establishment of BICs was launched, and 10 proposals were received, out of which 3 were shortlisted.

- Business Incubation Centers (BICs) were established at National University of Technology (NUTECH) and Bahauddin Zakariya University (BZU) Multan with an approved budget of Rs 48 million, of which Rs 24 million was released as the first installment.
- Existing BICs were provided second installment funding amounting to Rs 23.6 million.
- Recognition of BIC at Lahore Garrison University was completed under private sector initiative.
- The annual performance evaluation report of BICs through Self-Assessment Scorecards for FY 2025 was prepared and will be published in May 2026.

Offices of Research, Innovation and Commercialization (ORICs)

- Nine ORICs were established in public and private sector universities during the reporting period.
- A high-level task force was constituted to review ORIC performance and policy framework.

Digital Library (National Digital Library Program - NDLP)

- HEC Digital Library facilitated access to international research resources, achieving approximately 23 million downloads in 2025 reflecting increased user engagement.
- Periodic capacity building and training sessions were conducted for member institutions.

HEC Research Awards

- A total of 260 applications were received against the call for 2025-26. Of these, 221 were reviewed after initial scrutiny and 95 were shortlisted for detailed review.
- A rigorous external evaluation of 95 shortlisted applications resulted in the finalization of nine awards across three categories based on merit.

Pak-UK Education Gateway Project

- A Research Excellence Framework (REF) tailored to Pakistan was developed in collaboration with UK partners.
- Pilot testing involving 10 universities was completed and evaluation report compiled.

Enrolment of Students in Higher Education Institutes:

- Region and Sector-wise breakup of the enrolment statistics (On campus + Digital Learning) for the FY 2026 as follows:

Province/Region	Private	Public	Total
AJK	3,267	34,610	**37,877**
Balochistan	2,601	43,265	**45,866**
Federal*	61,281	678,860	**740,141**
Gilgit-Baltistan	-	12,082	**12,082**
Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	58,727	192,363	**251,090**
Punjab*	216,547	736,765	**953,312**
Sindh	142,964	206,285	**349,249**
Total	**485,387**	**1,904,230**	**2,389,617**

*: includes DL enrolment of AIOU and VU respectively.

Capacity Building of Faculty and Management of Universities and HEC (National Academy of Higher Education (NAHE)

1. Faculty Development Programs (IPFP & Specialized Initiatives)

- NAHE conducted a comprehensive set of faculty development initiatives aimed at enhancing teaching quality, academic leadership, and global exposure. A total of 517 participants were trained through flagship and specialized programmes. The IPFP (Batch V) remained the core programme with strong female participation, while the Fahm-ul-Quran programme demonstrated wide regional outreach. Additional trainings, such as Tier-II Faculty Training and the RELO Winter Program, further strengthened mid-career development and international learning opportunities.

2. HEIs Management & Leadership Development

- NAHE delivered targeted leadership and management programmes to strengthen institutional governance and strategic capacity within higher education institutions. A total of 117 participants were trained through specialized initiatives. The Strategic Leadership Program for Vice

Chancellors and Pro-VCs (Balochistan) demonstrated strong female representation, while the STEM Faculty Trainings under the Pak-UK Gateway Project contributed to enhancing faculty capacity in priority academic disciplines.

Programme-wise Summary

Programme	Cohorts/Batches	Participants	Key Highlight
IPFP (Batch V)	8 Cohorts	255	166 Female (65%)
Fahm-ul-Quran	5 Batches	232	Punjab (118), Sindh (55)
Tier-II Faculty Training	01	20	Mid-career faculty
RELO Winter Program	01	10	Global exposure
Strategic Leadership Program (VCs/Pro-VCs – Balochistan)	01	23	21 Female participants
STEM Faculty Trainings (Pak-UK Project)	03	94	Capacity building in STEM
BPS 11–16 Training Program	5 Cohorts	107	Professional skill development
Strategic & Governance Training (CSA Lahore)	5 Programs	95	Public sector leadership
Total		**836**	

3. Professional Development – HEC Employees

- NAHE implemented structured capacity-building programmes to enhance the skills, efficiency, and governance capabilities of HEC employees. A total of 202 participants were trained through targeted initiatives. The BPS 11-16 Training Program (5 cohorts) focused on professional skill development, while the Strategic & Governance Trainings at Civil Services Academy (CSA Lahore) strengthened leadership, integrity, and public sector performance.

Prime Minister's Laptop Scheme Phase – IV: The Prime Minister's Laptop Scheme is a flagship initiative of the Government of Pakistan, designed to bridge the digital divide and empower meritorious students across the country with access to modern technology. Under this scheme, a total of 1,00,000 laptops have been sanctioned for distribution to top-performing students of public-sector Higher Education Institutions (HEIs). As of April 2026, 74,427 laptops have been successfully distributed across all regions including Punjab, Sindh, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, Balochistan, Federal, AJK, and GB covering 156 HEIs nationwide. With over 4,07,713 students registered, including 54 percent female participation, the scheme reflects the government's commitment to inclusive, technology-driven education for Pakistan's future.

Laptop Distribution Status as on 20th April, 2026

Sr No.	Region	Universities	Registration	Allocation	Total Issued	Remaining	Region Wise %age
1	Azad Jammu & Kashmir	6	8610	2,096	1,885	211	90%
2	Balochistan	11	20307	18,000	2,153	15,847	12%
3	Federal Capital	17	62990	15,414	14,565	849	94%
4	Gilgit-Baltistan	2	3910	730	0	730	0%
5	Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	34	62174	14,249	11,594	2,655	81%
6	Punjab	54	176679	33,458	30,548	2,910	91%
7	Sindh	32	73043	16,053	13,682	2,371	85%
Total		**156**	**407,713**	**100,000**	**74,427**	**25,573**	**74%**

Concluding Remarks

Pakistan's education sector requires sustained reforms aimed at improving access, quality, learning outcomes, equity and governance across all levels of education. Enhanced public investment in education, modernization of curricula, promotion of digital learning and

strengthening of teacher training systems are essential to meet emerging national and global challenges. Special attention must also be given to technical and vocational education, skills development, and employment-oriented training. Pakistan's large youth population has significant potential, but this potential can only be realized if young people are equipped with relevant skills that match the needs of industries and the job market. Stronger links between educational institutions and industries can help improve employability and support economic growth. Through effective implementation of ongoing policy initiatives and reforms, the education sector can play a pivotal role in promoting economic growth, social cohesion, and sustainable national development.

TABLE 10.1

NUMBER OF EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS BY KIND, LEVEL & SEX

Numbers

Year	Primary* Schools (000)		Middle Schools (000)		High Schools (000)		Technical & Vocational Institutions		Higher Sec/ Inter Colleges		Degree Colleges		Univer-sities
	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total
2010-11	155.5	58.2	41.6	20.4	25.2	9.5	3,224	2,206	3,435	1,690	1,558	814	135
2011-12	154.7	57.0	41.9	21.0	28.7	11.6	3,257	2,229	4,515	2,184	1,384	643	139
2012-13	159.7	60.1	42.2	21.4	29.9	12.3	3,290	2,253	5,030	2,410	1,534	683	147
2013-14	157.9	60.3	42.9	21.1	30.6	12.6	3,323	2,276	5,179	2,462	1,086	518	161
2014-15	165.9	66.0	44.8	22.4	31.3	13.1	3,579	1,819	5,393	2,567	1,410	308	163
2015-16	164.6	65.3	45.7	27.0	31.7	15.6	3,746	1,514	5,470	1,437	1,418	260	163
2016-17	168.9	66.1	49.1	27.9	31.6	14.7	3,798	1,536	5,130	2,689	1,431	344	185
2017-18	172.5	73.5	46.7	23.5	31.4	13.5	3,740	1,330	5,754	2,654	1,659	834	186
2018-19	180.1	80.7	47.3	23.7	31.7	13.7	3,740	1,330	5,876	2,634	2,893	1,425	202
2019-20	180.1	85.4	47.0	26.9	31.7	14.5	3,740	1,330	5,898	2,738	2,983	1,500	209
2020-21	180.2	85.1	47.2	26.5	34.2	15.1	3,740	1,330	7,102	3,271	3,021	1,515	220
2021-22	162.1	70.8	47.8	24.2	34.6	15.1	4,182	1,629	8,113	3,711	2,487	1,235	220
2022-23	168.2	77.9	51.0	25.6	39.4	17.2	4,406	1,724	9,004	4,241	2,573	1,278	247
2023-24	158.7	69.3	44.4	22.6	44.9	22.5	4,549	1,811	11,258	5,671	2,468	1,272	239
2024-25 (E)	155.0	66.7	43.9	21.9	48.7	25.1	4,746	1,942	13,304	6,886	2,383	1,233	239

E: Estimated ***: Including Pre-Primary, Mosque Schools and Non-Formal Basic Education**

Notes:

1: All figures include Public & Private Sector data

2: Female institution includes percentage of mixed institutions

TABLE 10.2

ENROLMENT IN EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS BY KIND, LEVEL & SEX

Numbers

Year	Primary Stage I-V (000)		Middle Stage VI-VIII (000)		High Stage IX-X (000)		Technical & Vocational (000)		Higher Sec/ Inter Colleges (000)		Degree Colleges		Universities	
	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total	Female
2010-11	18,063	7,971	5,644	2,421	2,630	1,103	281	106	1,188	408	431,180	218,374	1,107,682	521,284
2011-12	18,677	7,905	6,020	2,573	2,753	1,155	290	109	1,294	367	497,152	222,098	1,319,799	642,198
2012-13	18,790	8,278	6,188	2,653	2,898	1,215	302	113	1,400	395	641,539	234,006	1,594,648	805,062
2013-14	19,441	8,567	6,461	2,798	3,109	1,303	309	117	1,234	497	465,435	240,585	1,594,648	805,062
2014-15	19,847	8,778	6,582	2,843	3,501	1,493	320	112	1,665	662	510,588	82,479	1,299,160	602,550
2015-16	21,551	9,534	6,922	3,026	3,653	1,580	315	112	1,698	675	518,144	86,134	1,355,649	602,509
2016-17	21,686	9,660	6,996	3,088	3,583	1,541	345	120	1,595	618	537,407	89,512	1,463,279	667,912
2017-18	22,931	10,093	7,362	3,273	3,861	1,692	433	148	1,688	765	604,614	294,388	1,575,793	695,028
2018-19	23,588	10,625	7,634	3,426	3,969	1,755	433	148	2,140	984	725,631	402,603	1,858,704	832,299
2019-20	23,758	10,698	7,870	3,544	4,015	1,784	433	148	2,227	1,019	771,636	416,679	2,001,695	913,559
2020-21	24,352	10,925	8,415	3,784	4,360	1,915	433	148	2,320	1,062	757,886	404,385	2,226,251	1,008,087
2021-22	23,849	10,732	8,767	3,996	4,490	2,001	438	153	2,146	990	623,392	333,327	2,226,251	1,008,087
2022-23	24,613	11,162	9,433	4,350	4,715	2,134	453	151	2,335	1,091	660,705	374,776	1,936,329	886,595
2023-24	25,376	12,221	10,819	5,161	5,422	2,508	457	159	2,971	1,498	909,135	550,244	1,964,147	898,410
2024-25 (E)	25,722	12,569	11,630	5,631	5,803	2,712	463	161	3,169	1,639	941,535	585,520	1,964,147	898,410

E : Estimated

Notes:

1. All figures include Public & Private Sector data

2. Enrolment of Deeni Madaris and Non-Formal Basic Education are included.

TABLE 10.3

NUMBER OF TEACHERS IN EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS IN PAKISTAN, BY KIND, LEVEL & SEX

Numbers

Year	Primary Schools* (000)		Middle Schools (000)		High Schools (000)		Technical & Vocational Institutions		Higher Sec/ Inter Colleges		Degree Colleges		Universities
	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total	Female	Total
2010-11	440.5	210.1	335.0	220.3	452.8	235.3	15,591	4,993	81,183	39,378	36,349	16,181	63,557
2011-12	427.4	198.6	351.4	233.9	458.7	271.3	15,847	5,079	97,633	52,746	40,191	16,815	70,053
2012-13	428.8	209.1	362.6	241.5	489.6	287.2	16,109	5,168	132,011	71,121	48,809	19,319	77,557
2013-14	420.1	209.5	364.8	243.6	500.5	296.3	16,377	5,259	124,336	58,867	25,964	7,599	77,557
2014-15	430.9	218.9	380.8	256.1	514.2	306.2	19,393	5,353	118,079	63,569	36,587	7,239	88,288
2015-16	444.6	226.3	394.2	270.3	529.5	318.0	18,157	4,384	123,061	66,528	37,082	7,379	83,375
2016-17	475.2	258.9	455.4	325.7	560.6	342.6	18,207	4,304	120,336	63,386	37,857	7,541	58,733
2017-18	522.4	284.0	448.1	319.8	563.3	342.9	18,207	4,304	123,154	64,320	41,233	17,803	56,885
2018-19	494.9	276.5	448.7	322.0	567.3	348.5	18,207	4,304	136,008	70,818	61,602	27,260	60,279
2019-20	485.2	267.3	442.7	316.6	566.7	346.9	18,207	4,304	137,660	70,441	60,064	26,836	64,817
2020-21	476.5	266.2	434.0	311.5	592.3	363.8	18,207	4,304	158,386	81,481	59,455	25,095	69,604
2021-22	463.1	260.0	434.3	313.4	587.1	364.4	18,347	4,738	170,240	88,766	57,709	25,372	69,604
2022-23	506.0	285.7	511.2	372.8	733.4	473.0	40,889	5,085	196,694	105,625	60,130	25,666	98,030
2023-24	439.7	228.7	434.5	300.4	827.5	532.3	41,104	5,227	299,434	166,237	58,311	24,666	102,123
2024-25 (E)	431.5	222.1	432.9	297.4	903.7	589.2	51,442	5,451	369,811	211,452	57,971	24,267	102,123

E : Estimated * : Including Pre-primary, Mosque Schools and Non-Formal Basic Education

Note: All figures include Public & Private Sector data

Sources:

1: Figures of Primary, Middle, High and Higher Sec. from 2010-11 to 2022-23 is based on Annual Pakistan Education Statistics Reports, NEMIS, PIE, Islamabad.

2: Figures of Universities is provided by Higher Education Commission (HEC), Islamabad.